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STEELING THE SHOW

Formerly the site of a U.S. Steel facility, a restored South Shore park may hold the key for Chicago birder aiming to spot a record 300 different birds this year

By Finnegan Belleau | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

As light mist obscured the far-off Chicago skyline, only the faint sounds of metal cranes clanging and construction vehicles beeping in the distance broke up the quiet morning at Park 566 in South Shore.

Peeking around tall patches of grass and peering through binoculars at Lake Michigan, Tarik Shahzad, a birder from the Norwood Park neighborhood, called Thursday's cold, wet conditions ideal for spotting birds late in the year.

"If you want to find one of the largest prairies in the city of Chicago with threatened and endangered bird species, five-lined skink (lizards) and a lot of peace and solitude with an incredible view of the city skyline and Lake Michigan, Park 566 is the place," he said.

Shahzad, 29, is on a mission to identify 300 birds in Cook County this year and only has two to go. He has already broken his own record of 296 spotted last year.

The tally is part of a challenge birders take on to see as many species as possible in a given area in 365 days.

In 2024, Shahzad first broke the bird spotting record in Cook County with 294 sightings. The race to spot more unique species every year has taken him across the county and even out onto Lake Michigan. The birder in second place had 12 fewer sightings as of Thursday afternoon, according to online database eBird.

Shahzad said he was desperately looking for a red crossbill Thursday but also hoped to see species of ducks and gulls that are rare to the area. He still took time to appreciate birds he had already spotted earlier this year, including Savannah sparrows flitting between grass stalks.

Birder Tarik Shahzad looks for unique species of birds during his walk in Park 566 on Thursday in the South Shore neighborhood of Chicago. **ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

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Immigration policies tied to Stephen Miller were a liability for Republicans in the election, polls showed.

Miller now top aide to Trump

Key deputy behind deportation agenda takes over for Wiles

By Seung Min Kim
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump said Friday that Stephen Miller was replacing Susie Wiles as White House chief of staff, installing as his closest adviser a loyal, combative bulldog for his "America First" agenda as the president prepares to stare down a newly empowered Democratic Congress next year.

Miller, long a key member of Trump's inner circle, is a key architect of the administration's hard-line immigration policies.

He is one of Trump's longest-serving aides, joining his long-shot 2016 presidential campaign as a speechwriter. He most recently served as White House deputy chief of staff for policy and oversees a broad portfolio, though he is best known for his role in Trump's immigration policy.

The staff shuffle signals that Trump, whose Republican Party was handed monumental defeats in Tuesday's midterm elections, is resisting a conciliatory approach to Democratic lawmakers who

See **MILLER** on Page A8

ARCH BLOCKED: A federal judge Thursday night promptly blocked construction of President Donald Trump's 250-foot triumphal arch near the entrance of Arlington National Cemetery after a Trump-friendly panel approved it. **Nation & World, Page B4**

ANALYSIS: Unpopular Trump pays price in midterm elections. **Nation & World, Page B5**

At U. of C., a sanctuary for words

Banned books scholar hopes to arm teachers with cultural capital

By Darcel Rockett
CHICAGO TRIBUNE



Dulcey Hunter, a banned books postdoctoral scholar at the University of Chicago, stands in the university's Regenstein Library on Oct. 15. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Already well known for being a sanctuary city for refugees and immigrants, in 2022, Chicago became a different kind of refuge — one for banned books. It was then that the city and Chicago Public Library officials established "Book Sanctuaries" across 77 community areas and 81 library branches, expanding local access to banned or challenged books.

Then, in 2023, Illinois became the first state to enact a law that allows the secretary of state's office to withhold grant funding from municipal and school district libraries if they don't adopt the American Library Association's Library Bill of Rights, which holds that "materials should not be proscribed or removed because of partisan or doctrinal disapproval.

That same year, the University of Chicago Library launched a similar effort with its Banned Books Initiative, which collects books banned and challenged in the U.S. and makes them available on campus for reading and checkout in digital formats and through interlibrary loan.

The institution's library now has its first scholar focused on banned books.

Dulcey Hunter, an English language arts educator who taught middle and high school students in Florida for more than

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"My work explores how book-banning efforts reflect a broader cultural narrative, reflecting struggles over whose stories may be told, whose suffering is permitted cultural visibility and whose experiences may be collectively understood."

DULCEY HUNTER, a banned books scholar at the University of Chicago

IBM introduces its first quantum computer in Ill.

By Robert Channick
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

IBM unveiled its first quantum computer in Illinois Friday at Hyde Park Labs, ushering in an era of potentially transformative technological advancement, with Chicago at the center of development.

Initially installed at the University of Chicago's commercial research and development facility, the IBM Quantum System Two will eventually move to the Illinois Quantum and Microelectronics Park rising up at the former U.S. Steel site on the city's South Side.

"As IBM's first quantum computer in Illinois, the system's deployment marks a milestone for Illinois' quantum community and builds on IBM's partnerships across the state as we expand quantum research across academia and industries," Arvind Krishna, chairman and CEO of IBM, said in a news release.

In December 2024, IBM and the state announced plans to build the National Quantum Algorithm Center at the Illinois Quantum and Microelectronics Park, a computer research development envisioned as the

See **IBM** on Page A4

SPORTS

Monangai back on practice field

Bears tailback Kyle Monangai was back in practice Friday and could play as soon as Sunday night against the Buccaneers, which would be a boost against the league's No. 1 run defense and help take a load off D'Andre Swift.



CHRIS SWEDA/TRIBUNE

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